Schedule

PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

Gordon Wright

19 January 2026

Term 2 Schedule

ℹ Term Dates

- **Term Start**: Monday 12 January 2026
- **Reading Week**: 16-20 February 2026
- **Term End**: Friday 27 March 2026

Weekly Overview

Week	Dates	Topic	Lecture	Lab	Assessment
11	12-16 Jan	DataLab	None	DataLab	
12	19-23 Jan	Distributions & Variability	Yes	Descriptives in R	
13	26-30 Jan	Estimation & CIs	Yes	Bootstrap CIs	
14	2-6 Feb	Inference & t-tests	Yes	t-tests in R	
15	9-13 Feb	Correlation	Yes	Correlation in R	
—	16-20 Feb	**Reading Week**	—	—	Work on Research Plan

Week	Dates	Topic	Lecture	Lab	Assessment
16	23-27 Feb	Regression	Yes	Project groups	**Research Plan due Fri 27 Feb**
17	2-6 Mar	Interpretation & Credibility	Yes	Project groups	
18	9-13 Mar	MCQ Exam	**MCQ Exam**	Project groups	**MCQ Exam Mon 9 Mar**
19	16-20 Mar	Project Workshop	Yes	Project groups	**EDS due Fri 20 Mar**
20	23-27 Mar	Wrapping Up	Yes	Report writing	

Session Times

Session	Day	Time	Location
Lecture	Wednesday	10:00-12:00	RHBD 143
Lab Group A	Thursday	10:00-12:00	WB 304a
Lab Group B	Thursday	10:00-12:00	Wb 304b

⚠ Week 11 Note

There is no lecture in Week 11 due to employability events.

Assessment Deadlines

Assessment	Weight	Deadline	Week
Research Plan	20%	Friday 27 February 2026, 12 noon	16
MCQ Exam	20%	Monday 9 March 2026, in lecture slot	18
EDS Assignment	20%	Friday 20 March 2026, 12 noon	20
Research Report	40%	Friday 1 May 2026, 12 noon	Post-term

Week-by-Week Detail

First Half: Building Skills (Weeks 11-15)

Week 11: DataLab

- Generate the dataset you'll use all term

- Form your project groups
- No lecture

Week 12: Distributions & Variability

- First lecture (2 hours)
- Mean, median, mode, standard deviation
- Introduction to R for descriptives
- *Report writing: Descriptive statistics*

Week 13: Estimation & Confidence Intervals

- Point estimates vs interval estimates
- Bootstrap confidence intervals
- Effect sizes (Cohen's d)
- *Report writing: CIs and effect sizes*

Week 14: Inference & t-tests

- Null hypothesis logic
- p-values and significance
- Between vs within designs
- t-tests and their nonparametric alternatives
- *Report writing: t-test results*

Week 15: Correlation

- Scatterplots and relationships
- Pearson vs Spearman
- Correlation ≠ causation
- Last week before Reading Week
- *Report writing: Correlation results*

Reading Week

- Work on your Research Plan (due Week 16)
- Review material for MCQ (Week 18)
- No taught sessions

Second Half: Application & Assessment (Weeks 16-20)

Week 16: Regression

- **Research Plan due Friday**
- From correlation to prediction
- Line of best fit
- Labs now in project groups
- *Report writing: Methods section*

Week 17: Interpretation & Credibility

- P-hacking and HARKing
- Replication crisis
- MCQ prep in lecture
- *Report writing: Introduction section*

Week 18: MCQ Exam

- **MCQ Exam Monday (in lecture slot)**
- Lab is project support
- *Report writing: Introduction continued*

Week 19: Project Workshop

- APA results reporting
- Project analysis support
- EDS preview
- *Report writing: Discussion preview*

Week 20: Wrapping Up

- **EDS Assignment due Friday**
- Lecture: Project data showcase, lab report structure, discussion sections
- Lab: Final analysis support and report writing
- *Report writing: Discussion section — interpreting findings, limitations, implications*

Key Dates Summary

```
Jan 12-16     Week 11: DataLab (first contact)
Jan 19-23     Week 12: First lecture

Feb 13        Last day before Reading Week
Feb 16-20     Reading Week
Feb 27        Research Plan due (noon)

Mar 11         MCQ Exam (lecture slot)
Mar 20        EDS Assignment due (noon)

May 1         Research Report due (noon)
```